太初
Primordial

为琵琶与弦乐四重奏而作

Composed for Pipa and String Quartet

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“太初”是一个中文词汇，常用于哲学和宗教中，尤其是在道教和一些古代哲学中。它代表无形质，只有先天一炁，比混沌更元始的宇宙状态。在道教经典《道德经》中，老子提到“道”是宇宙的根本法则和起源，“太初”可以理解为“道”的最初状态，是一切事物形成之前的状态，在哲学讨论中，太初常被用来探讨存在的本质、时间的起源以及物质世界的形成等深奥问题，而在文学作品中，“太初”也常常被用来象征纯粹、原始或理想化的状态。

我在接受中国道教文化的熏陶之后，常常会对本原进行思考，不仅仅是对事物，更是对自己本身，我理解的“太初”既是混沌，又是一切的开端和统一，在我的作品中，我将“太初”孕育在琵琶与弦乐碰撞冲击中，采用动静结合流动式的五声、七声旋律，从混沌的开始到中期的爆发最后再回到平静般的原始，这一切的循环往复便是我想通过中西乐器进行泛调性的结合来使太初进行具象化的表现。

“Primordial” is a Chinese term commonly used in philosophy and religion, particularly in Daoism and some ancient philosophies. It represents an intangible essence, the primordial qi, which signifies a more original state of the universe than chaos. In the Daoist classic *Dao De Jing*, Laozi mentions that the "Dao" is the fundamental principle and origin of the universe. “Primordial” can be understood as the initial state of the "Dao," existing before all things took form. In philosophical discussions, "Primordial" is often used to explore the nature of existence, the origin of time, and the formation of the material world, among other profound issues. In literary works, it often symbolizes purity, primitivity, or an idealized state.

Having been influenced by Chinese Daoist culture, I frequently contemplate the concept of the original essence, not only concerning things but also regarding myself. My understanding of “Primordial” encompasses both chaos and the beginning and unity of all things. In my works, I embody “Primordial” through the collision and impact of the pipa and string instruments, employing a dynamic interplay of flowing pentatonic and heptatonic melodies. This journey progresses from the chaos of the beginning, through an explosive midpoint, and ultimately returns to a tranquil, primal state. This cyclical process represents my intention to use a combination of Chinese and Western instruments to achieve a tangible expression of “Primodial.”

Notation: Pipa:

L	拍	大指将弦勾起即放，重声作断弦声。
K	提	大指、食指提起一弦即放，重声作断弦声，轻声成乐声。

拍：大指将弦勾起即放，重声作断弦声
Pai: The thumb plucks the string and then releases it, creating a sound that mimics a snapped string.
提：大指、食指提起一弦即放，重声作断弦声，轻声或乐声
Pull: The thumb and index finger lift a string and then release it, producing a strong sound that mimics a snapped string, along with soft sounds or musical tones.

ᵏ	摘	大指指甲面压在弦上，食指或中指在下面弹出得声。
ᵇ	弹面板	食指或大指用指甲面用力弹击面板。

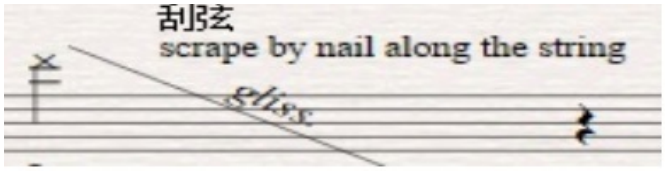
摘：大指指甲面压在弦上，食指或中指在下面弹出得声
Zhai: The nail surface of the thumb presses down on the string, while the index or middle finger plucks from underneath to produce sound.
弹面板：食指或大指用指甲面用力弹击面板
Striking the surface: The index or thumb uses the nail surface to strike the soundboard with force.

☆	轮	即轮指。食、中、名、小指依次弹出，紧接大指挑进，连得五声。亦有以小、名、中、食指依次弹出，大指挑进，连得五声为“下出轮。”
☆------	长轮	两个以上的“轮”连接在一起。

轮：即轮指。食、中、名、小指依次弹出，紧接大指挑进，连得五声亦有以小、名、中、食指依次 弹出，大指挑进，连得五声为“下出轮”
Lun: Refers to the technique of using the fingers in sequence. The index, middle, ring, and little fingers pluck one after the other, followed by the thumb pulling in, producing a continuous sequence of five sounds. There is also a variation where the little, ring, middle, and index fingers are used in sequence, followed by the thumb, which also results in a continuous sequence of five sounds known as 'lower out lun.'
长轮：两个以上的“轮指”连接在一起
Long Lun: Two or more "Lun" techniques connected together.

	轮双	同时轮两根弦。
	满轮	同时轮四根弦或三根弦。

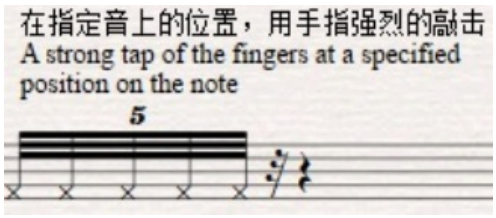
轮双：同时轮两根弦
Double Lun: Plucking two strings simultaneously.
满轮：同时“轮”四根线或三根弦
Full Lun: Plucking four strings or three strings simultaneously.
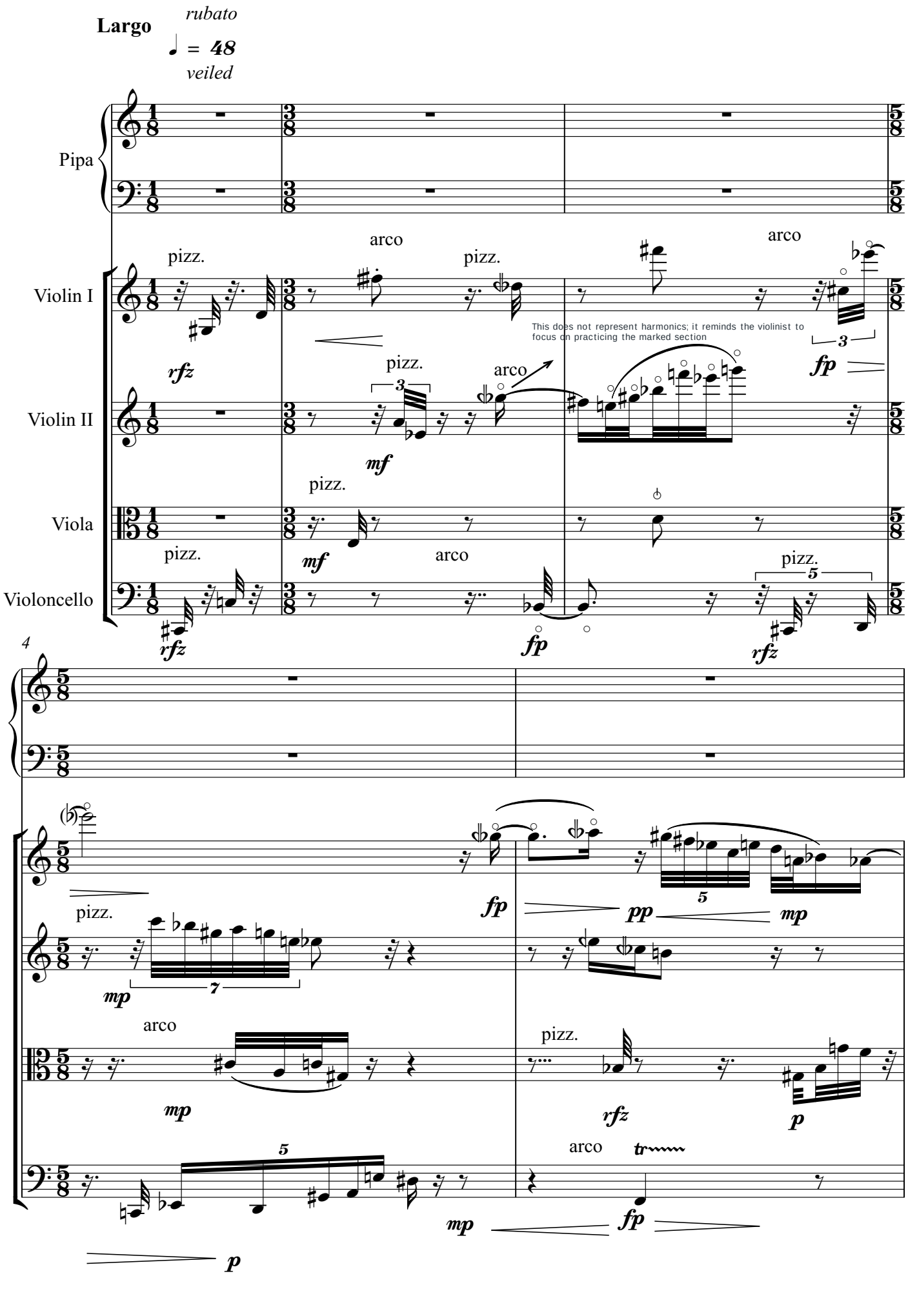


∧	虚　按	左手指浮按弦，不实按音位，同时右手弹奏，它发的音不是纯乐音，故在音符上加用斜线销去。
⊥	煞	左手指甲抵弦身，右手弹得煞声，它发的音不是纯乐音，故在音符上加用斜线销去。
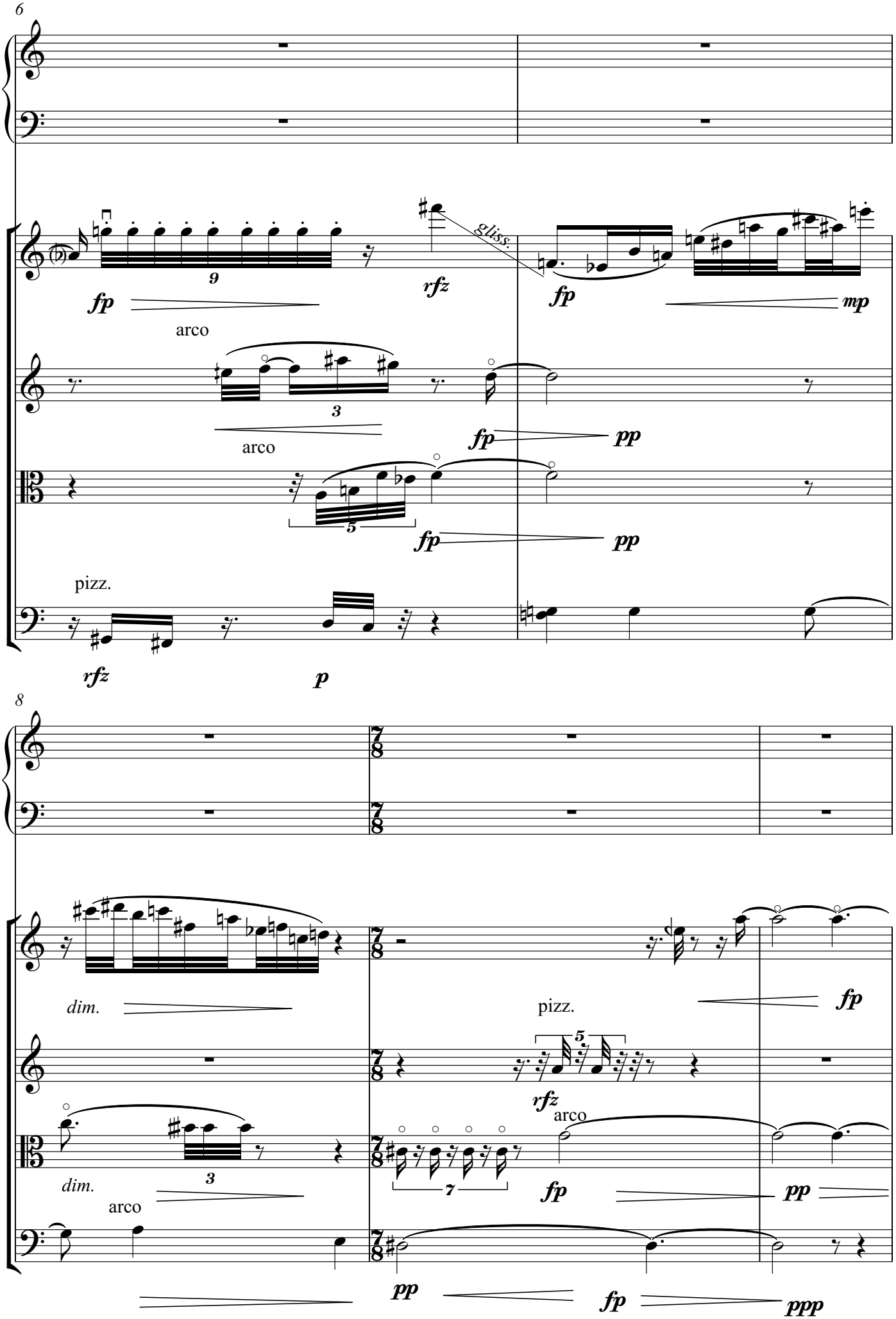
虚按：左手指浮按弦，不实按音位，同时右手弹奏
False Press: The left hand lightly presses on the string without firmly pressing down on the pitch, while the right hand plays.
煞：左手指甲抵弦身，右手弹得煞声
Sha: The fingernail of the left hand rests against the body of the string, while the right hand produces a sharp sound.

String instrument:
+：左手拨弦
+: Left hand pizzicato.
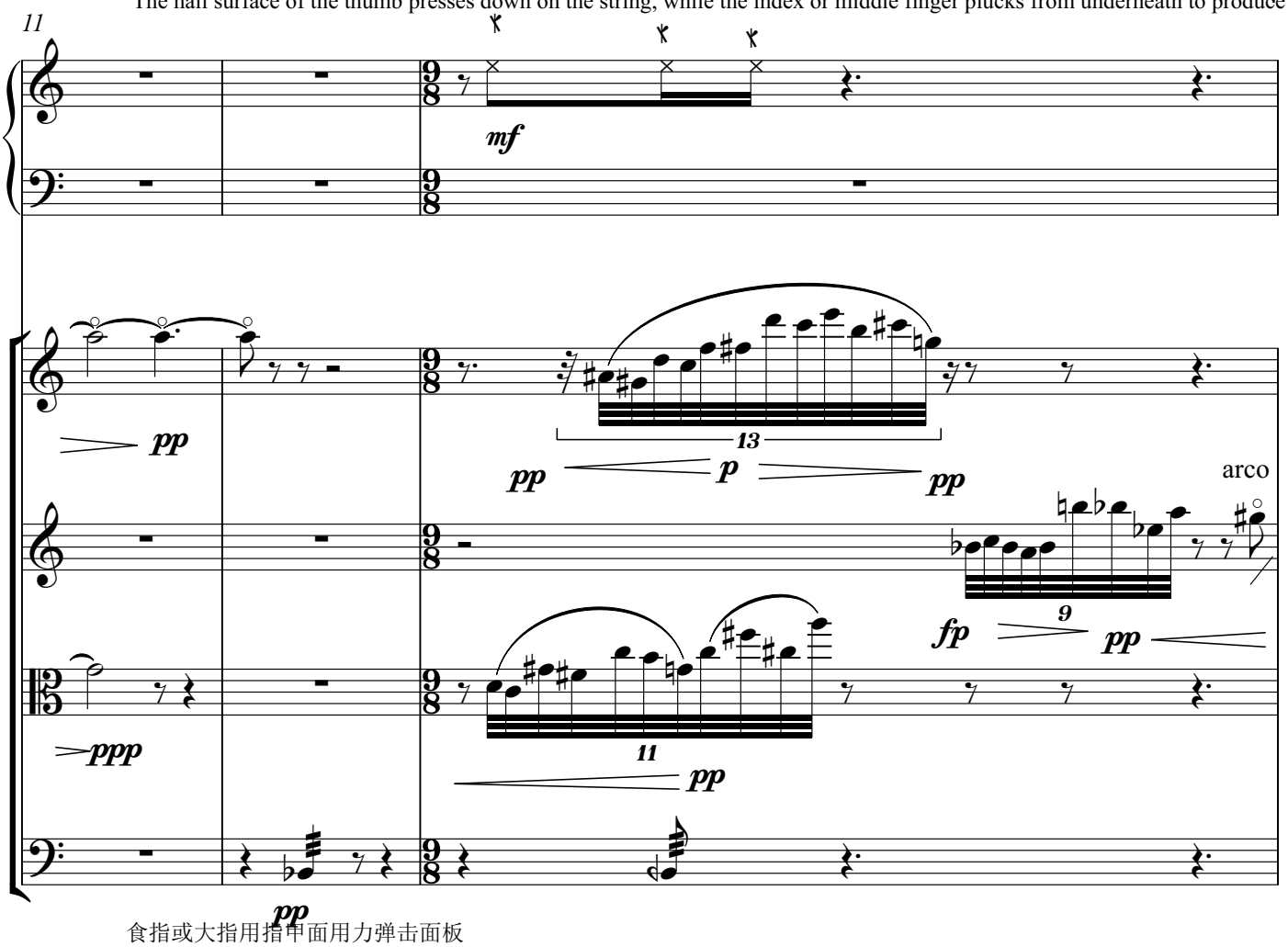


时长：6分7秒
Duration: 6 minutes and 7 seconds




6
9
fp
rfz
gliss.
fp
mp
arco
3
arco
fp
pp
5
fp
pp
pizz.
rfz
p
8
dim.
pizz.
fp
5
rfz
arco
dim.
3
7
fp
pp
arco
pp
fp
ppp
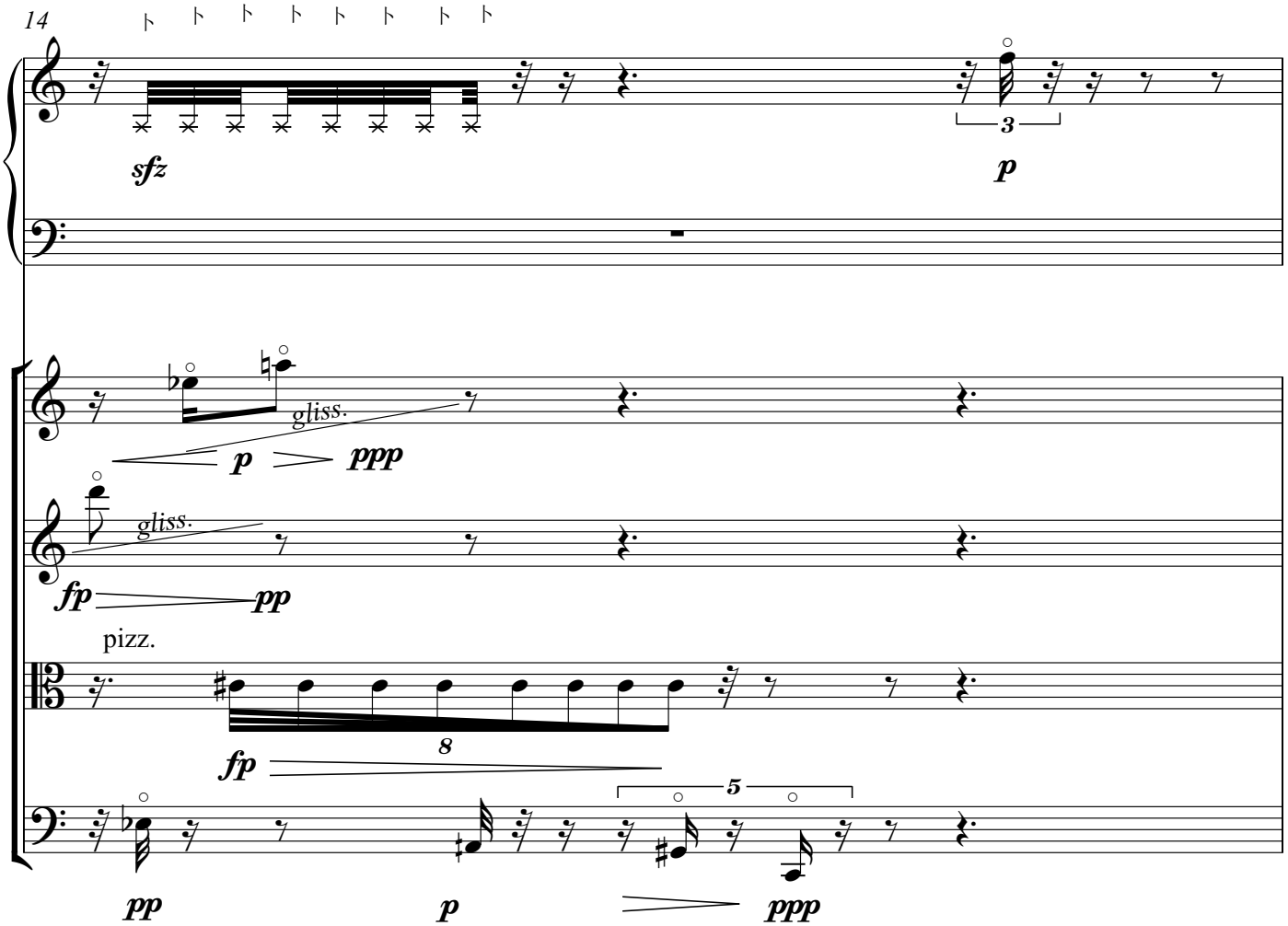
大指指甲面压在弦上，食指或中指在下面弹出得声

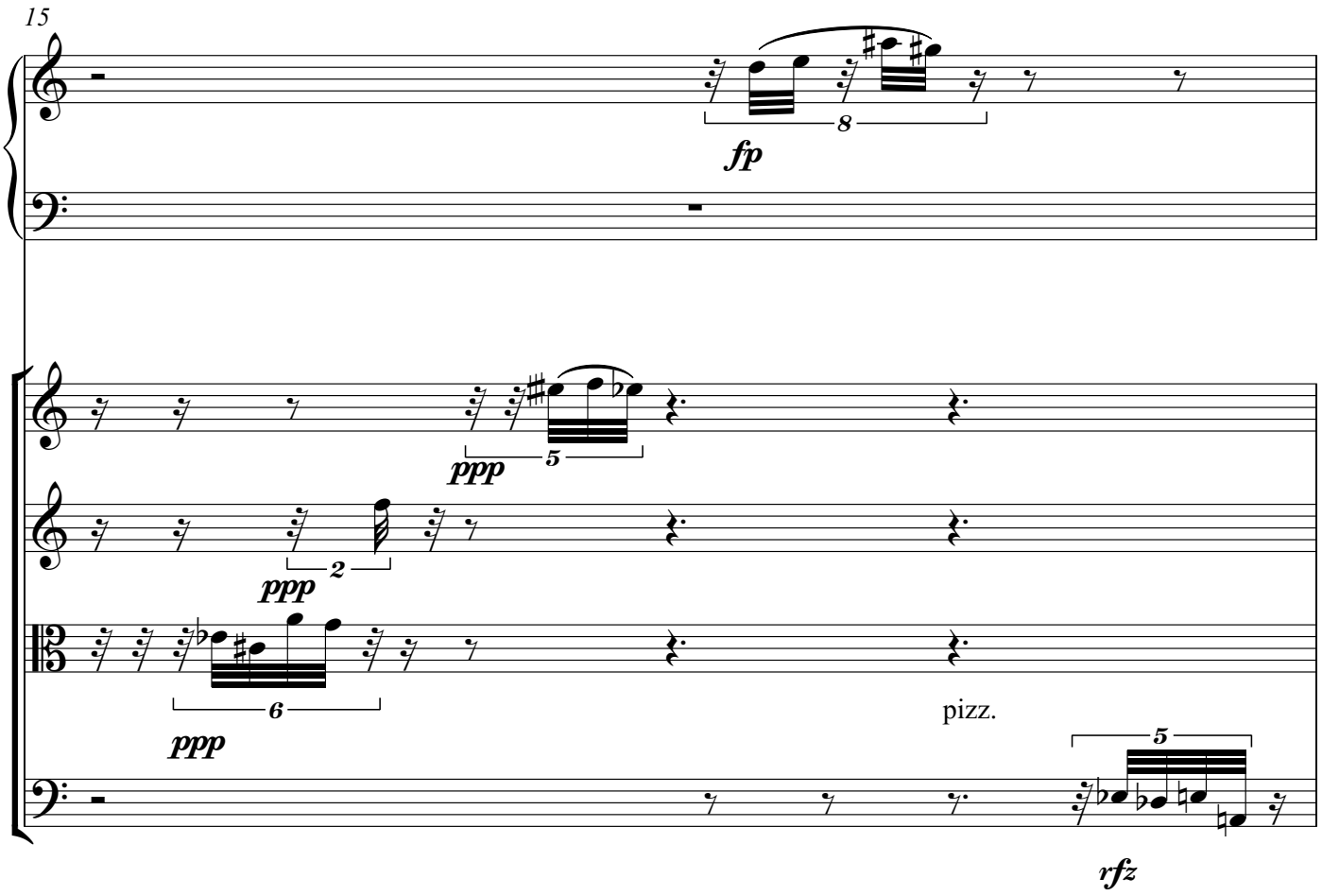
The nail surface of the thumb presses down on the string, while the index or middle finger plucks from underneath to produce sound.
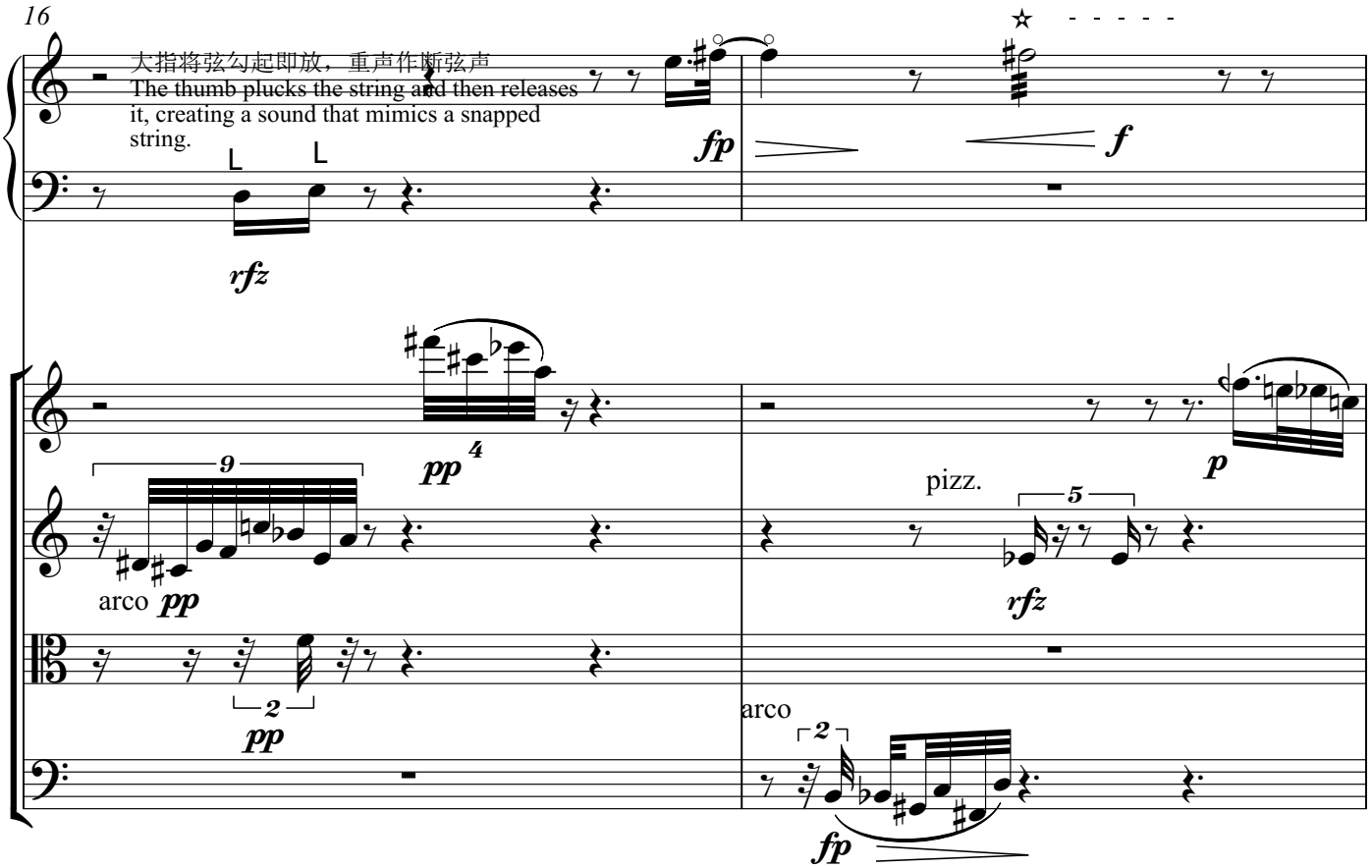


食指或大指用指甲面用力弹击面板

The index or thumb uses the nail surface to strike the soundboard with force.





两个以上的“轮指”连接在一起
Two or more "Lun" techniques connected together.



同时“轮”两根弦
Plucking two strings simultaneously.

18

mp fp f mp rfz

pizz. arco gliss. fp mp mp pizz. rfz

Adagio *grottesco*

♩ = 56

20

mf pp f mf pp p ff

arco tr fp mp pp p

pizz. rfz arco mp rfz p

26

刮弦
scrape by nail along the string

gliss.

fp

pp

3

pizz.

(tr)

pp

mf

5

mp

p

7

fp

mp

6

p

fp

4

arco

fp

mp

mf

p

mp

4

pizz.

rfz

28

mp

mf

rfz

5

9

fp

arco

mp

7

fp

3

pp

ppp

+

3

mp

在指定音上的位置，用手指强烈的敲击
A strong tap of the fingers at a specified position on the note
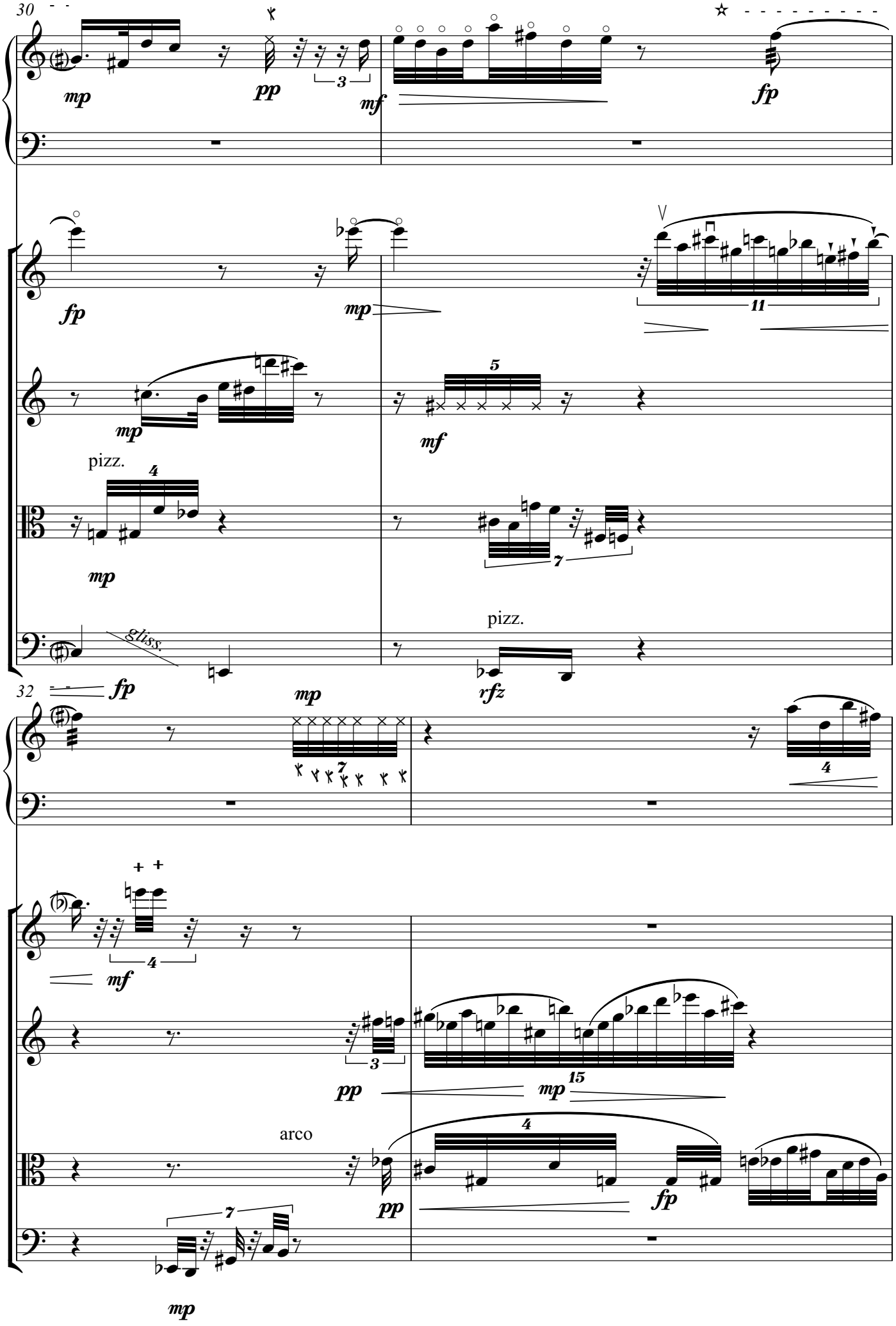
arco
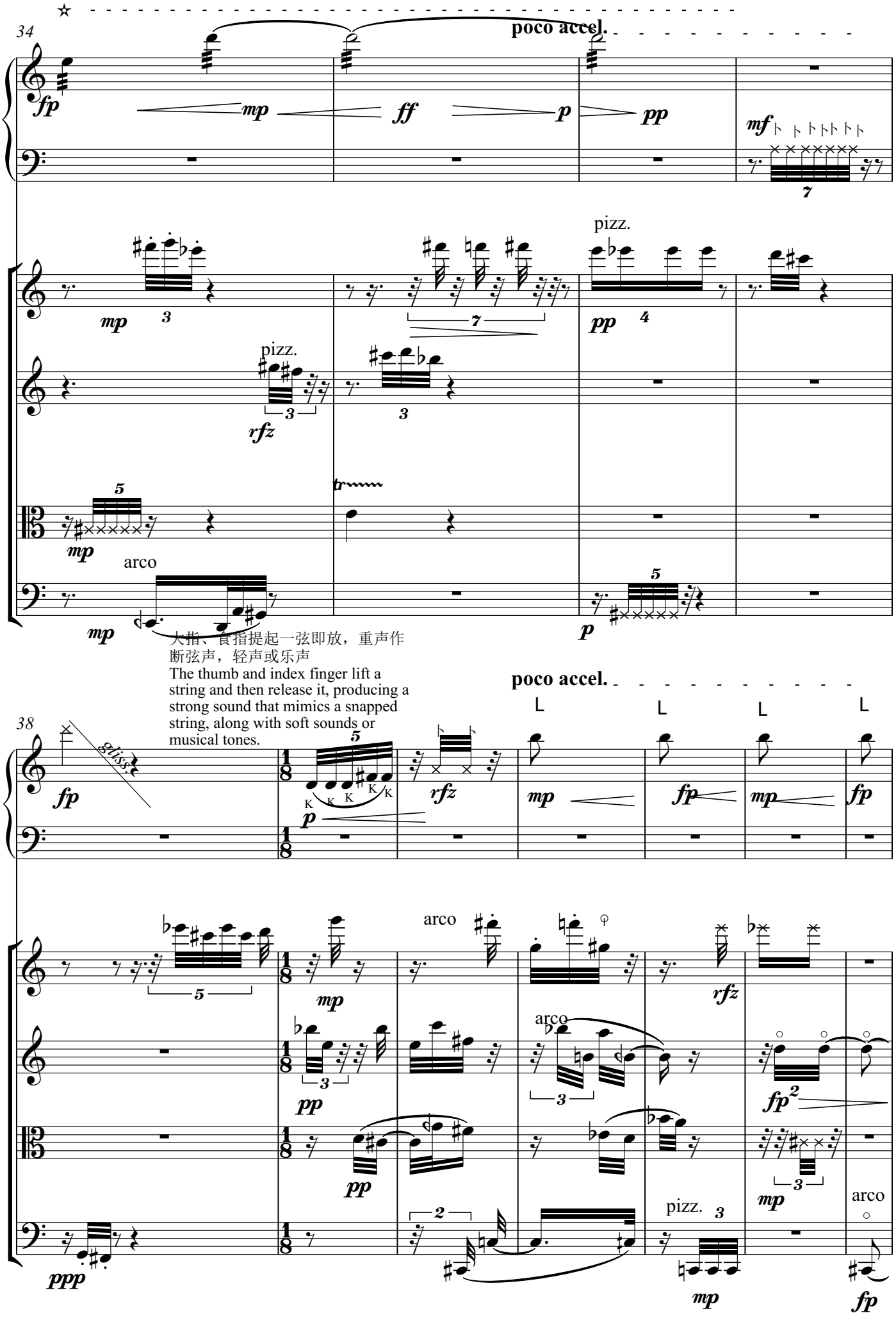
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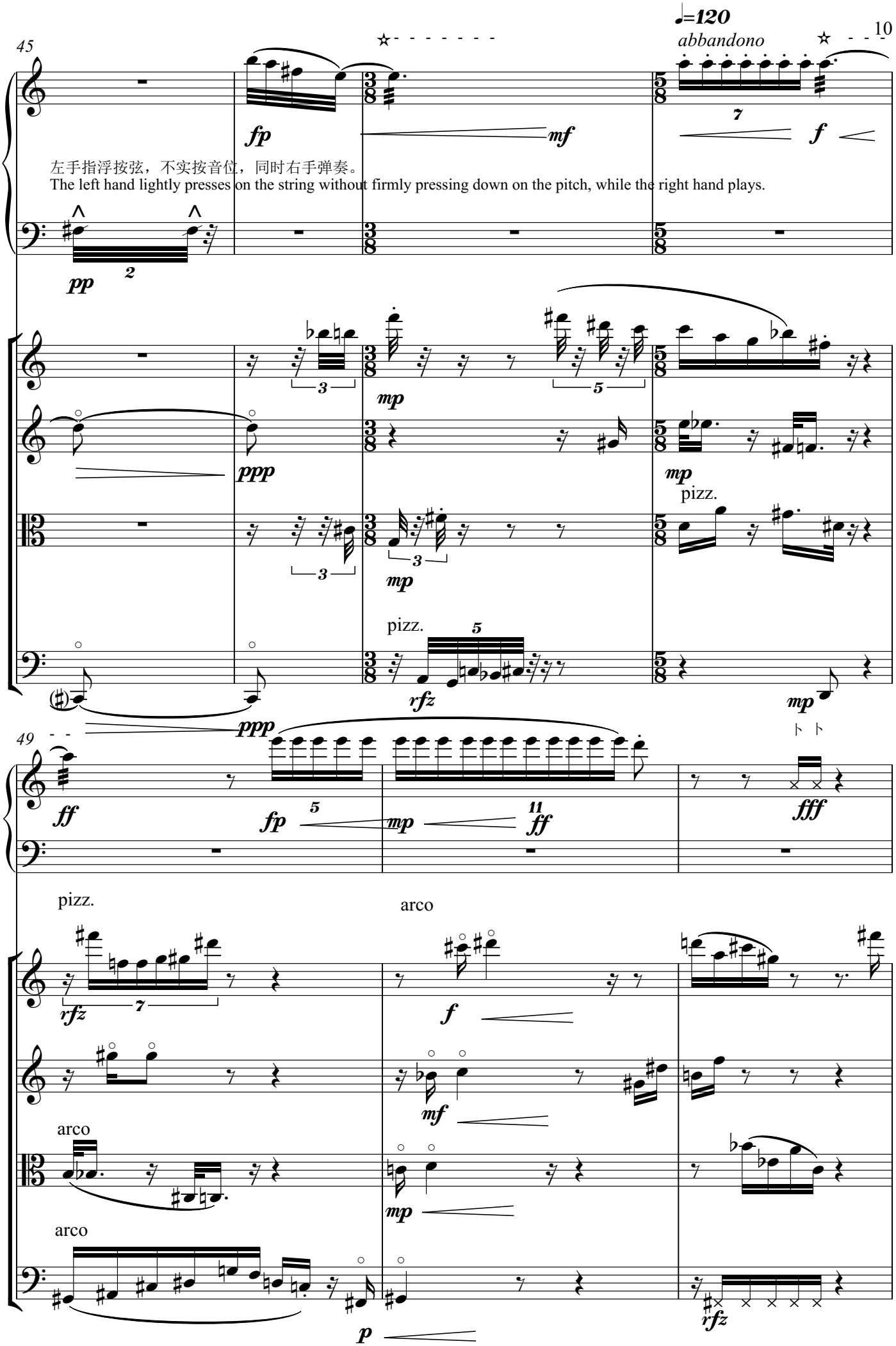
mf
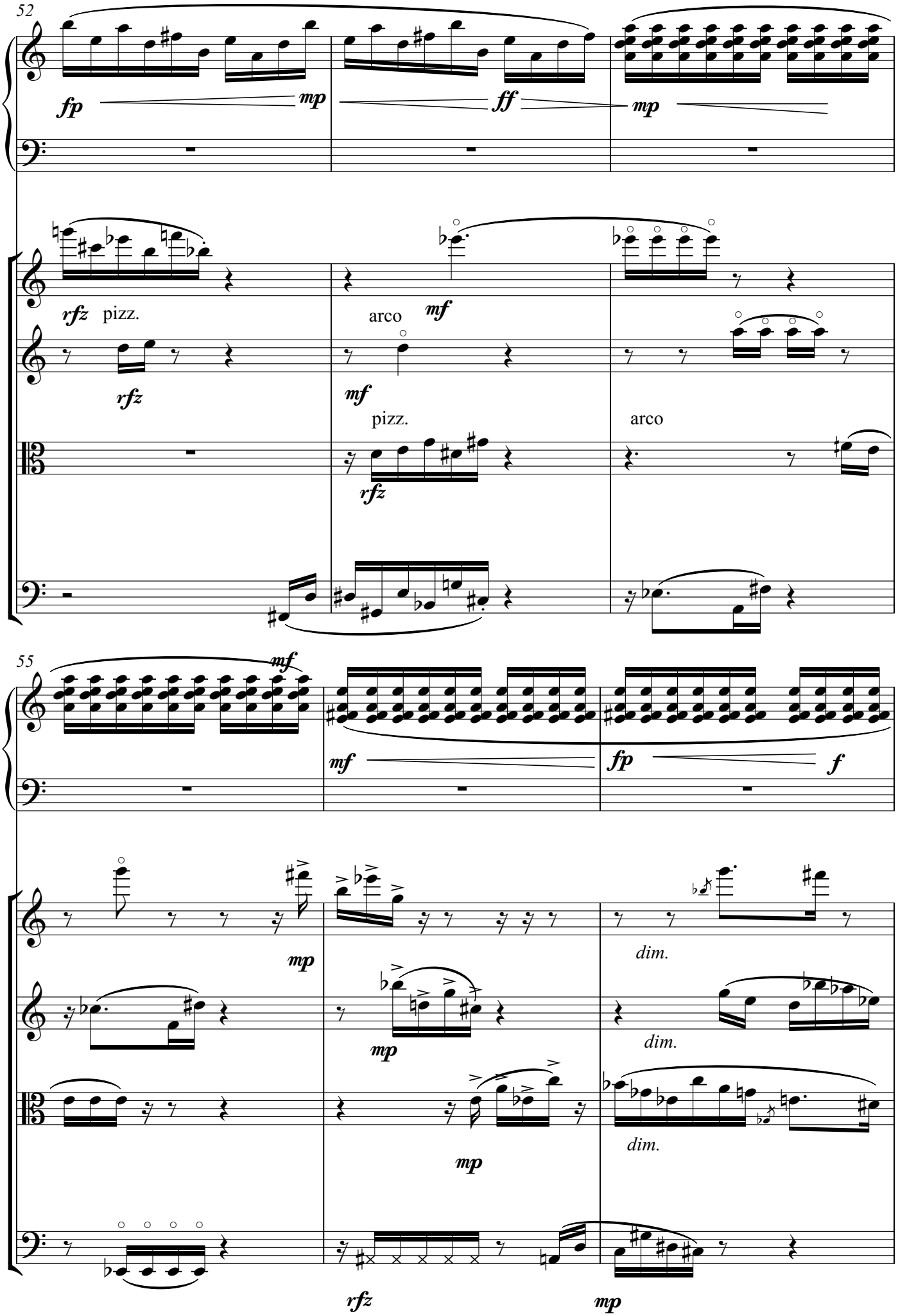
7

mp


30
mp
pp
mf
fp
fp
mp
11
mp
5
mf
pizz.
4
mp
7
gliss.
pizz.
fp
rfz
32
mp
7
4
+ +
4
mf
3
pp
mp
15
arco
4
pp
fp
7
mp


34
poco accel.
fp
mp
ff
p
pp
mf
pizz.
rfz
arco
大指、食指提起一弦即放，重声作断弦声，轻声或乐声
The thumb and index finger lift a string and then release it, producing a strong sound that mimics a snapped string, along with soft sounds or musical tones.
38
poco accel.
gliss.
rfz
fp2
ppp


45
♩=120
abbandono
fp
mf
f
左手指浮按弦，不实按音位，同时右手弹奏。
The left hand lightly presses on the string without firmly pressing down on the pitch, while the right hand plays.
pp
ppp
mp
pizz.
rfz
49
ff
fp
mp
ff
fff
arco
mf
p


52
fp
mp
ff
mp
rfz
pizz.
rfz
arco
mf
mf
pizz.
rfz
arco
55
mf
mf
fp
f
mp
dim.
mp
dim.
mp
dim.
rfz
mp

♩=108

58

mp

p

fp

p

pp

6

arco

pizz.

6

pp

pizz.

pizz. rfz

pp

rfz

左手指甲抵弦身，右手弹得煞声
The fingernail of the left hand rests against the body of the string, while the right hand produces a sharp sound.

62

f

mf

fp

pp

mf

7

pp

mf
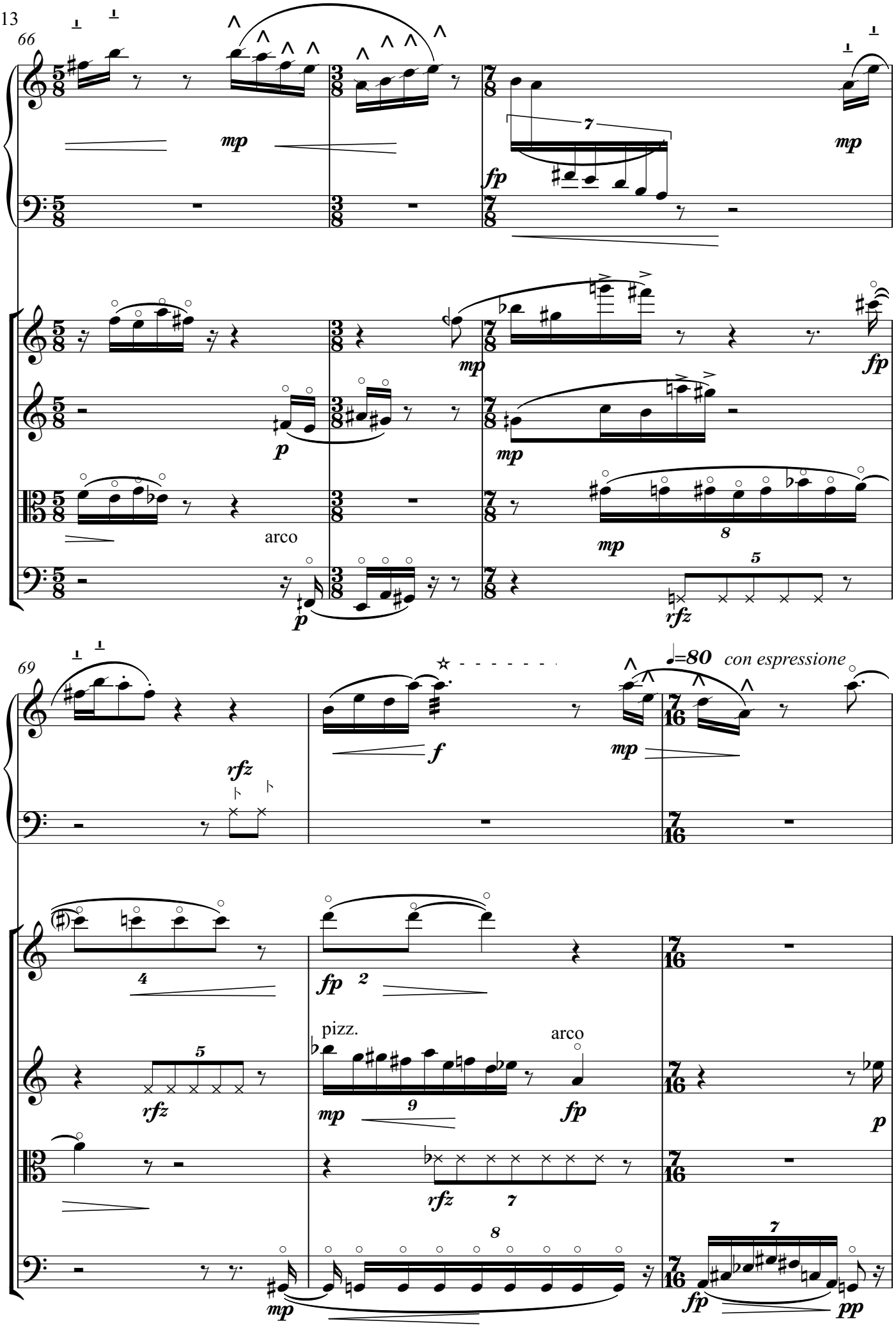
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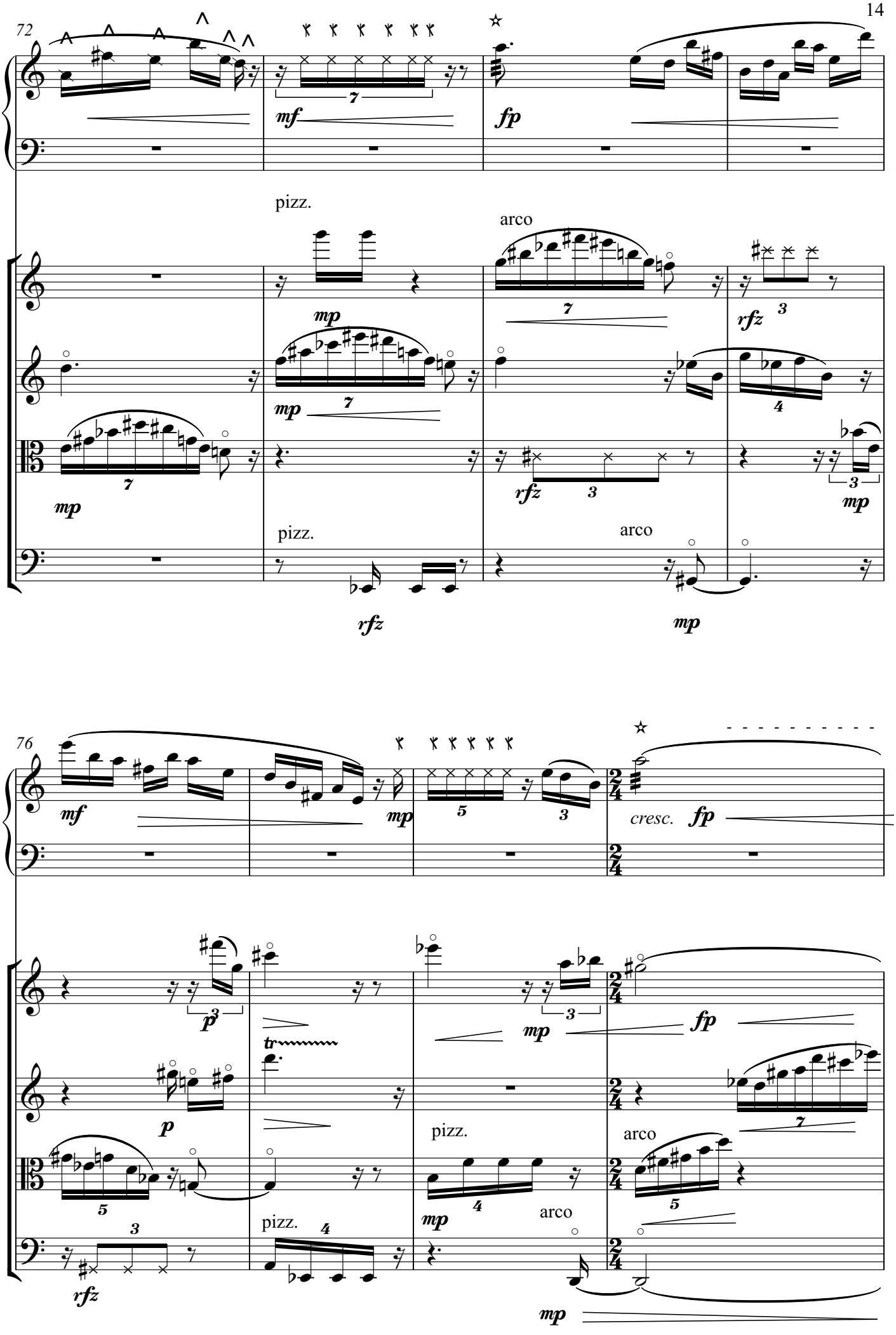
arco
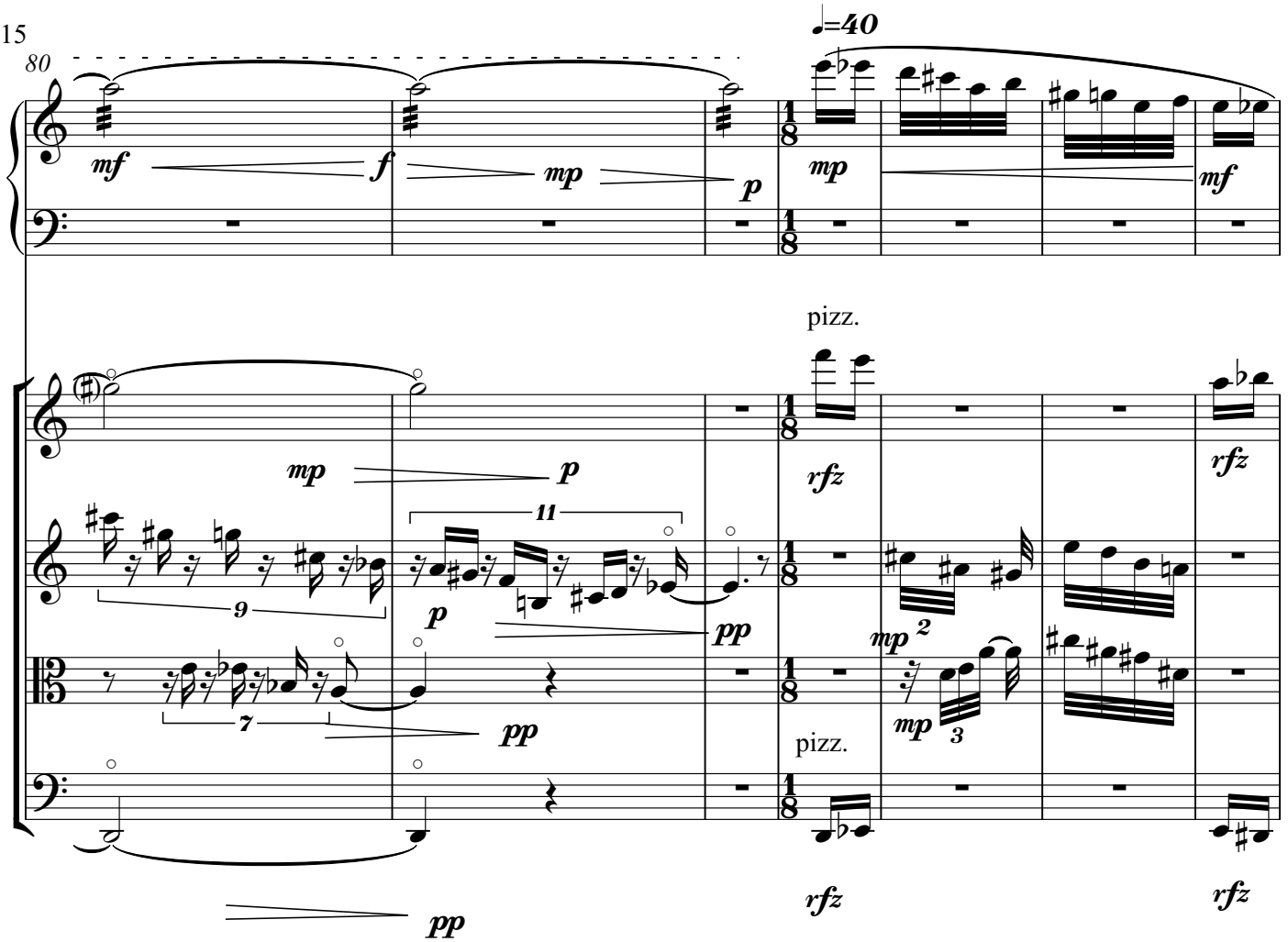
mp
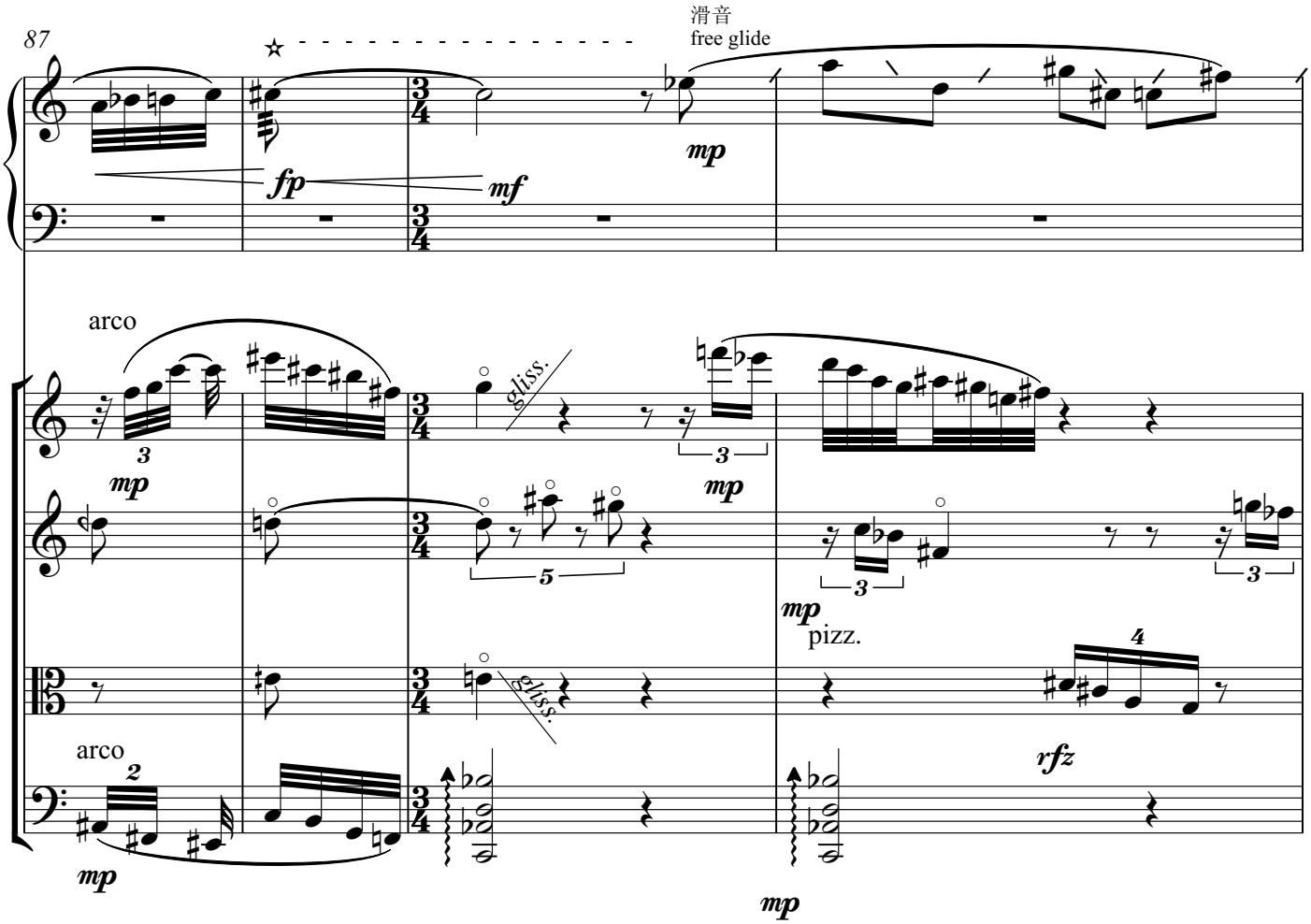
pp
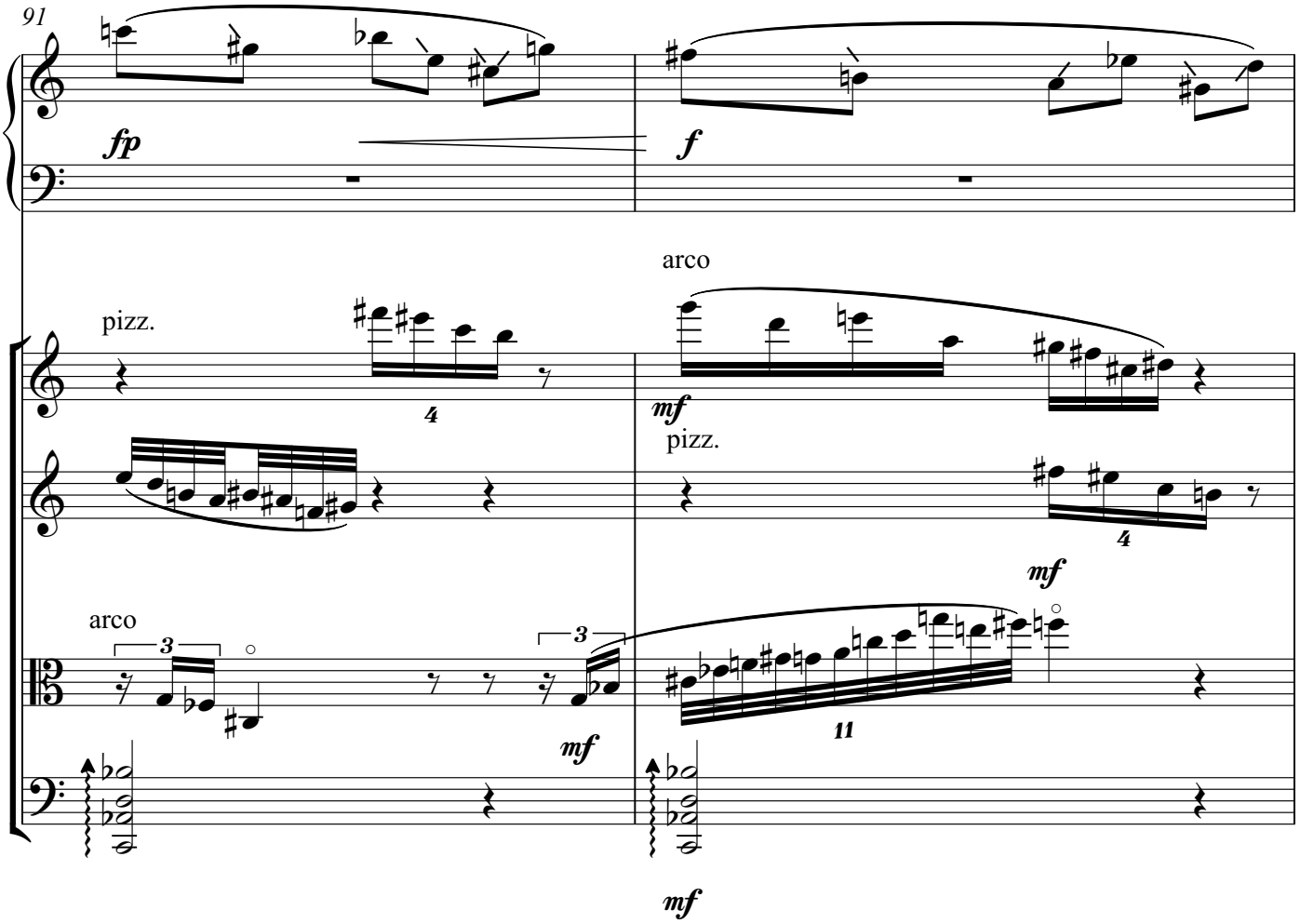
mp


66
mp
fp
mp
p
mp
fp
arco
p
mp
8
mp
5
rfz
69
♩=80 con espressione
rfz
f
mp
4
fp 2
5
rfz
pizz.
arco
mp 9
fp
p
rfz 7
8
7
mp
fp
pp
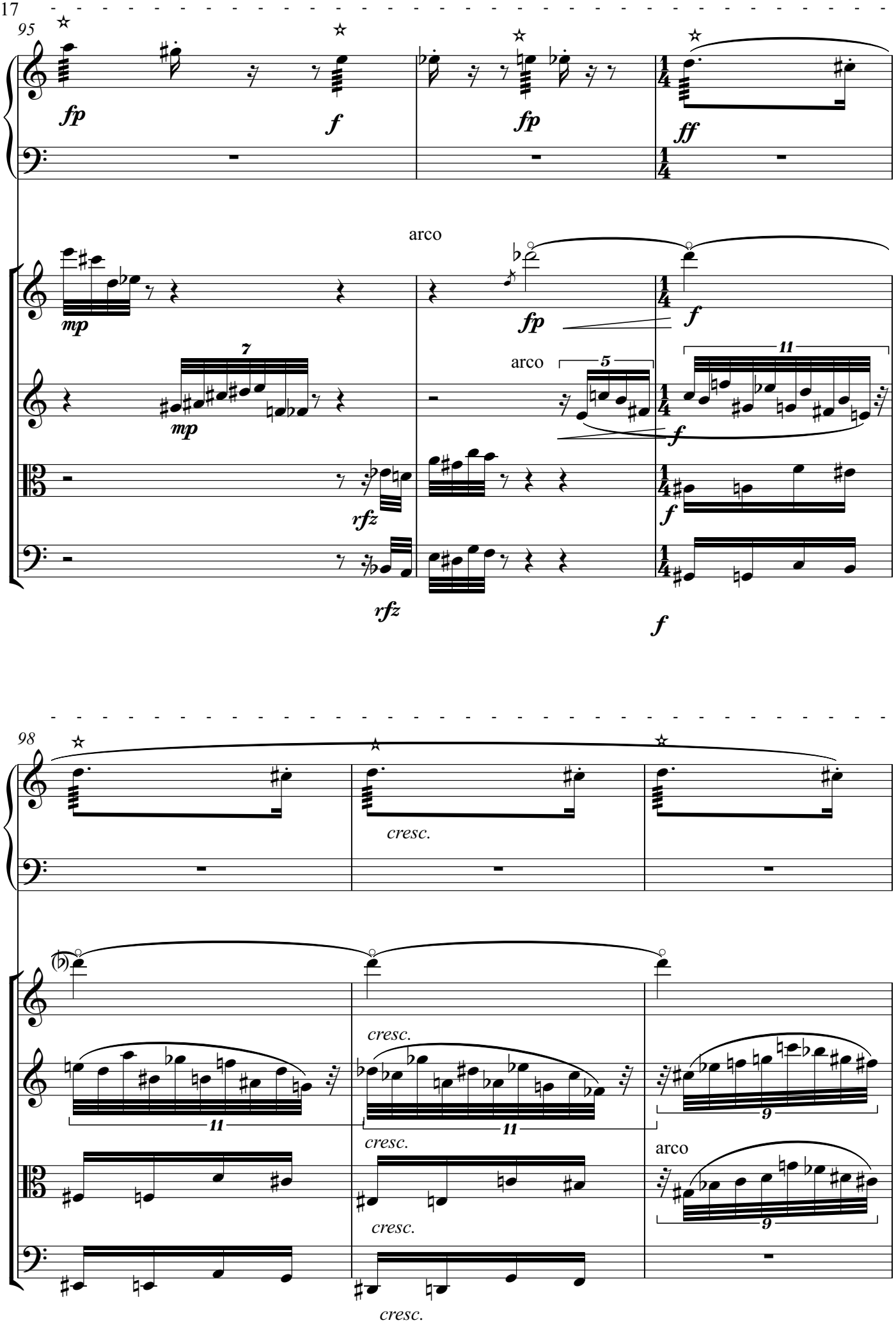

72
mf
fp
pizz.
arco
mp
rfz
76
cresc.
tr
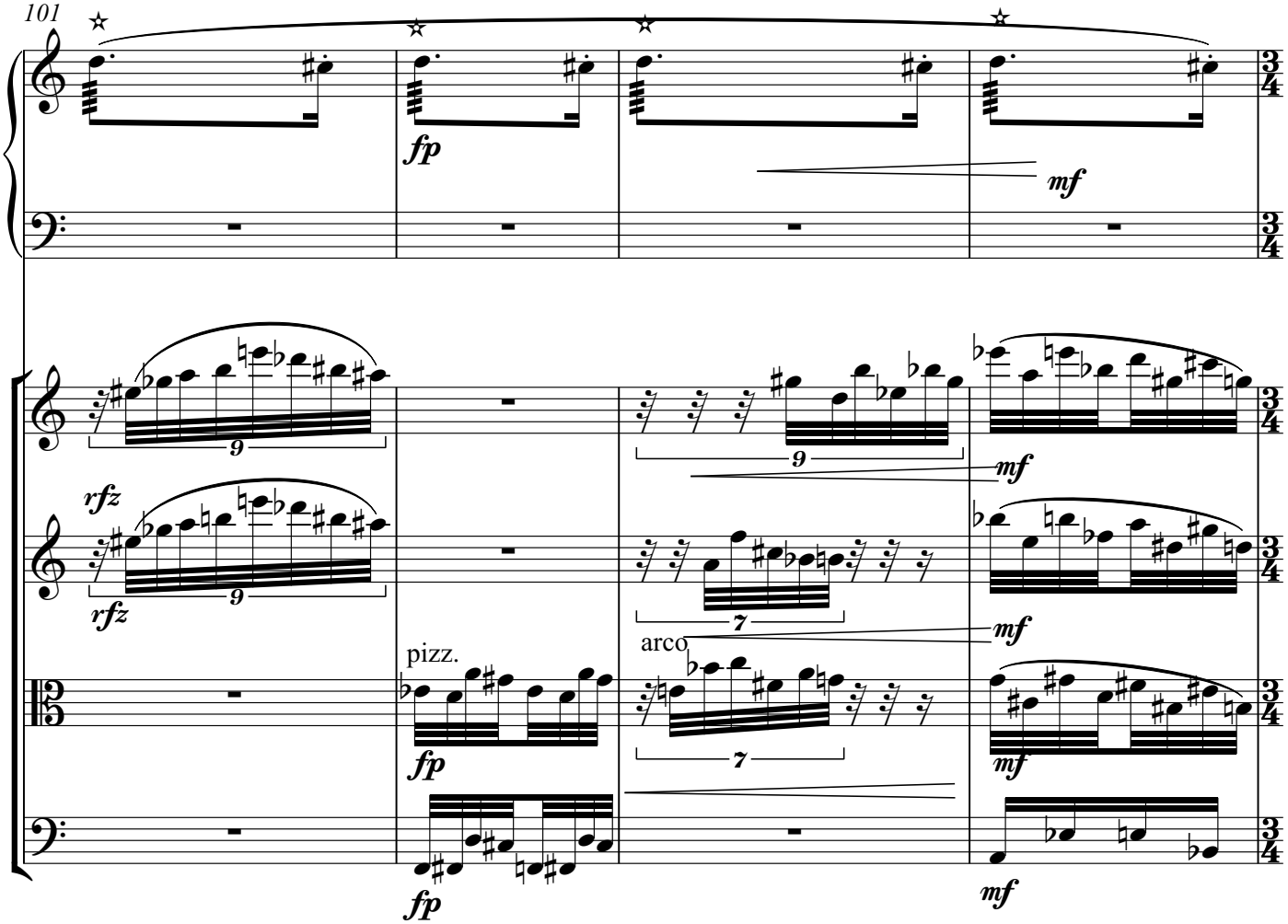

80
♩=40
mf
f
mp
p
mp
mf
pizz.
mp
p
rfz
rfz
11
9
p
pp
mp
2
7
pp
mp
3
pizz.
pp
rfz
rfz


87
滑音
free glide
fp
mf
mp
arco
3
mp
gliss.
3
mp
5
3
mp
pizz.
4
arco
2
rfz
mp
mp
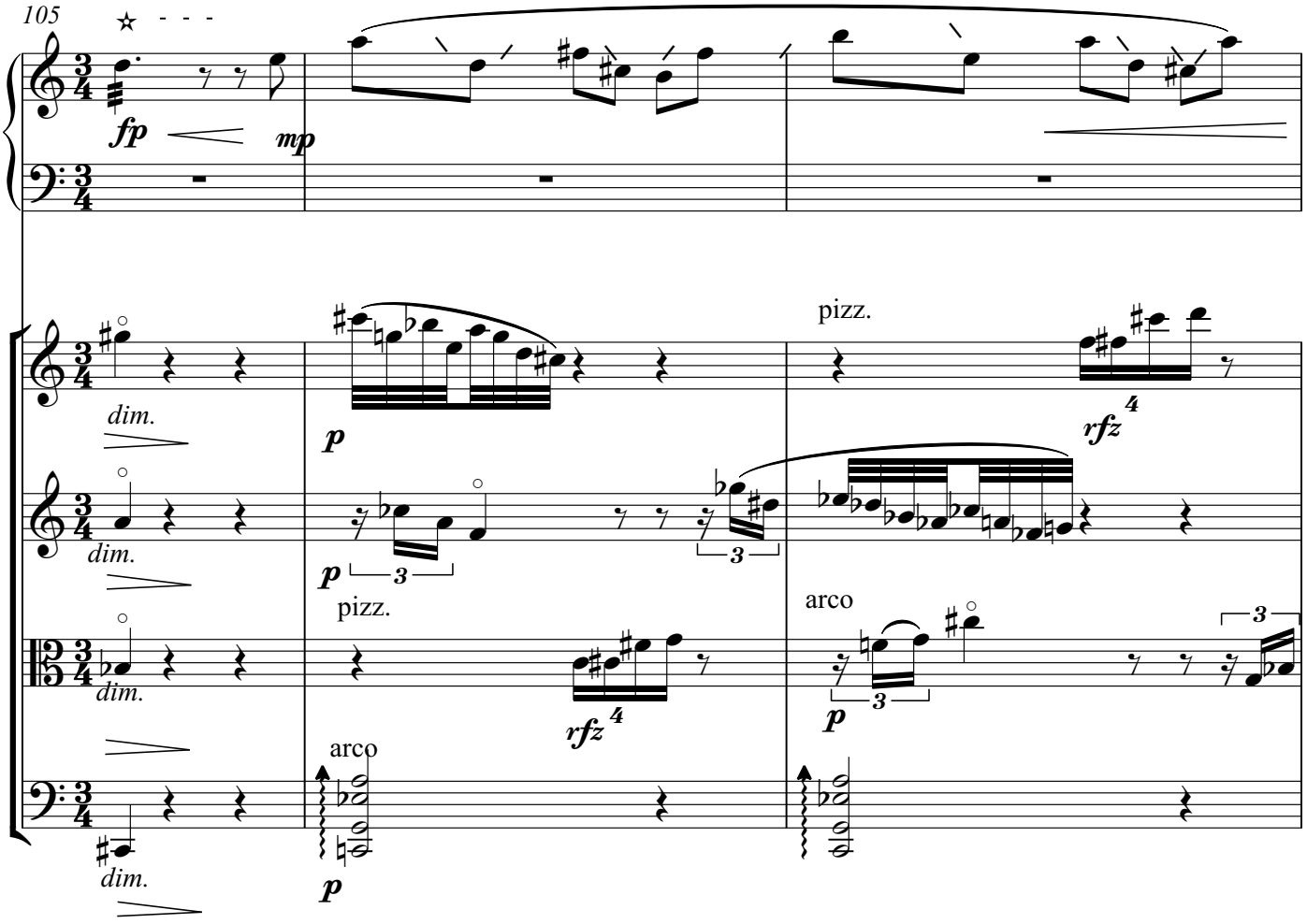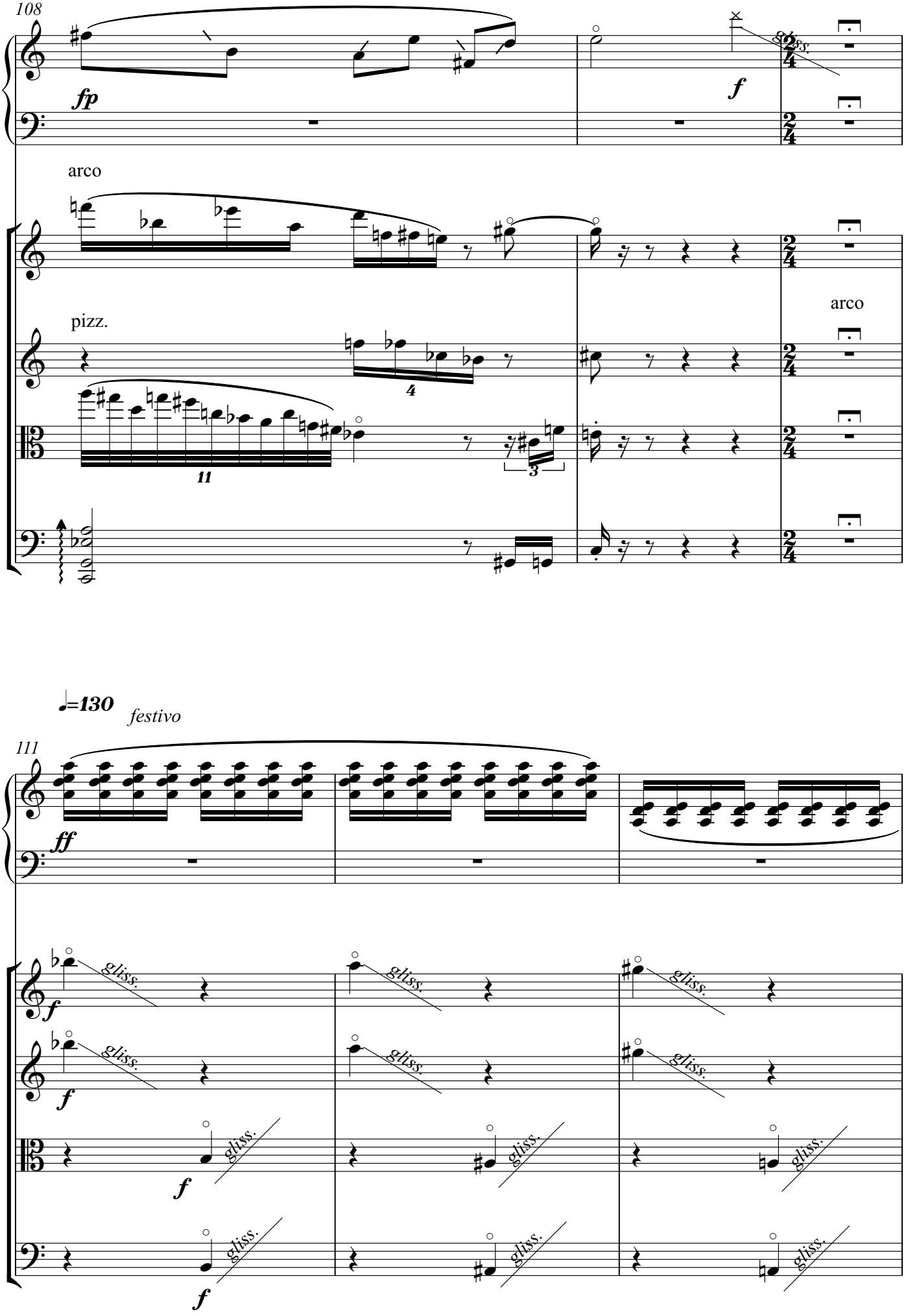


accel. - - -
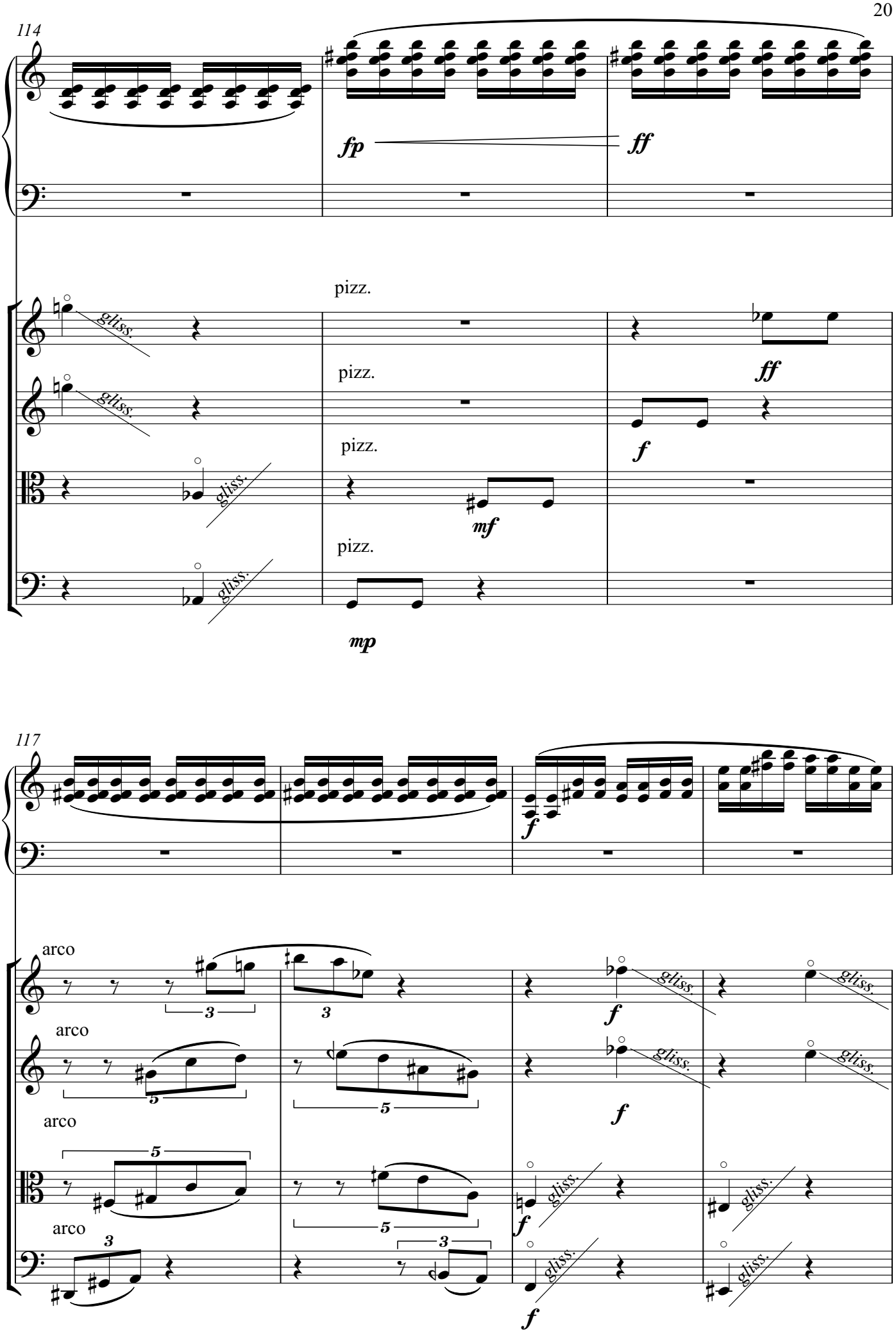

95
fp
f
fp
ff
arco
mp
fp
f
7
mp
arco
5
11
f
rfz
f
rfz
f
98
cresc.
cresc.
11
11
9
arco
9
cresc.
cresc.
cresc.


101
fp
mf
rfz
rfz
mf
pizz.
fp
arco
mf
fp
mf

A tempo


105
fp
mp
dim.
p
pizz.
rfz
dim.
p
dim.
pizz.
rfz
arco
p
dim.
arco
p


108
fp
gliss.
f
arco
pizz.
arco
4
11
3
♩=130
festivo
111
ff
gliss.
f


114
fp
ff
pizz.
gliss.
ff
f
mf
mp
117
arco
3
5
f
gliss.

121

molto rit.

fp ff

pizz. arco

gliss. ff pizz. arco

f pizz. arco

mf pizz.

mp

同时“轮”四根线或三根弦
Plucking four strings or three strings simultaneously.

ritenuto

126
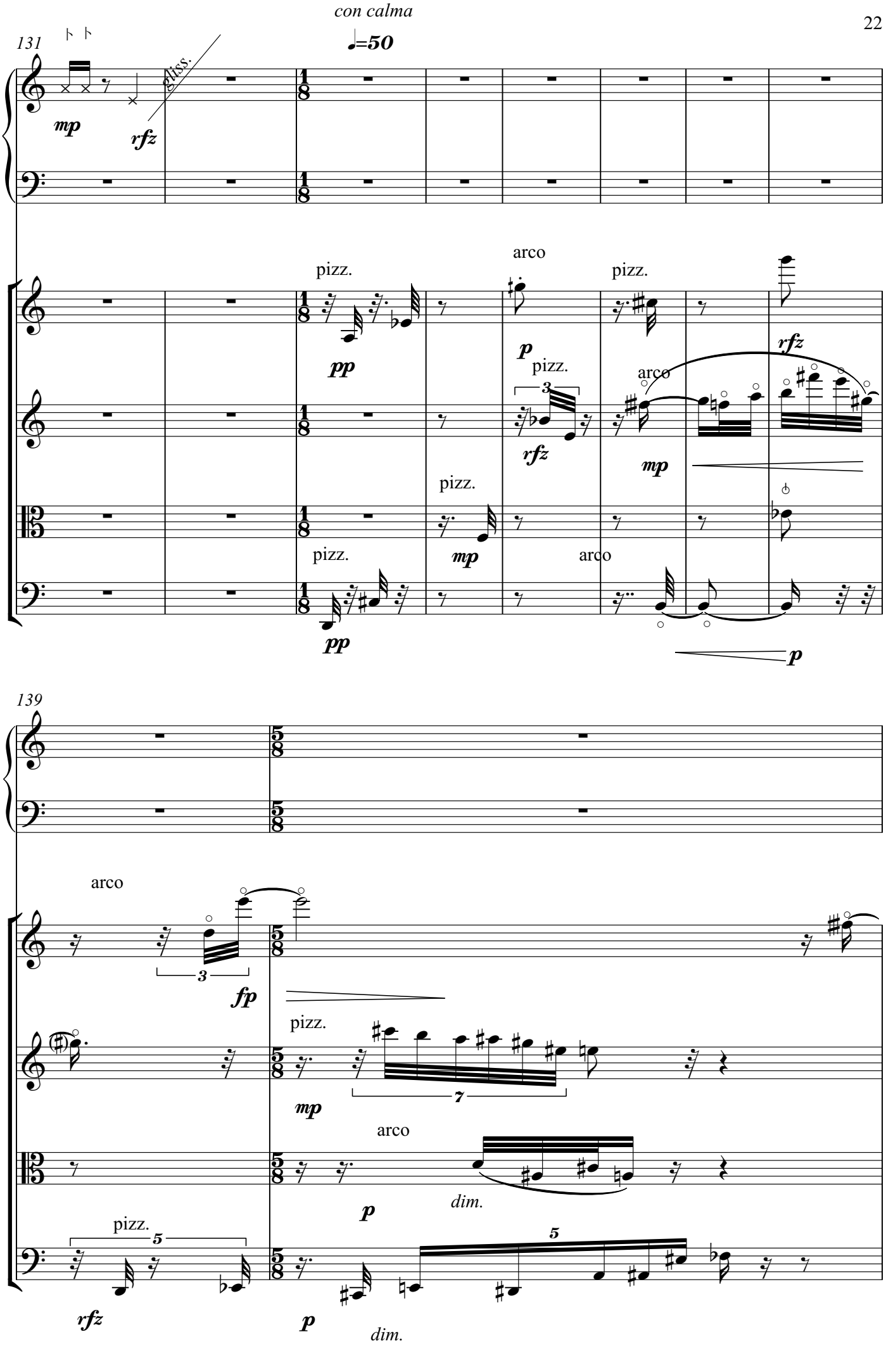
mf f fp mf mp
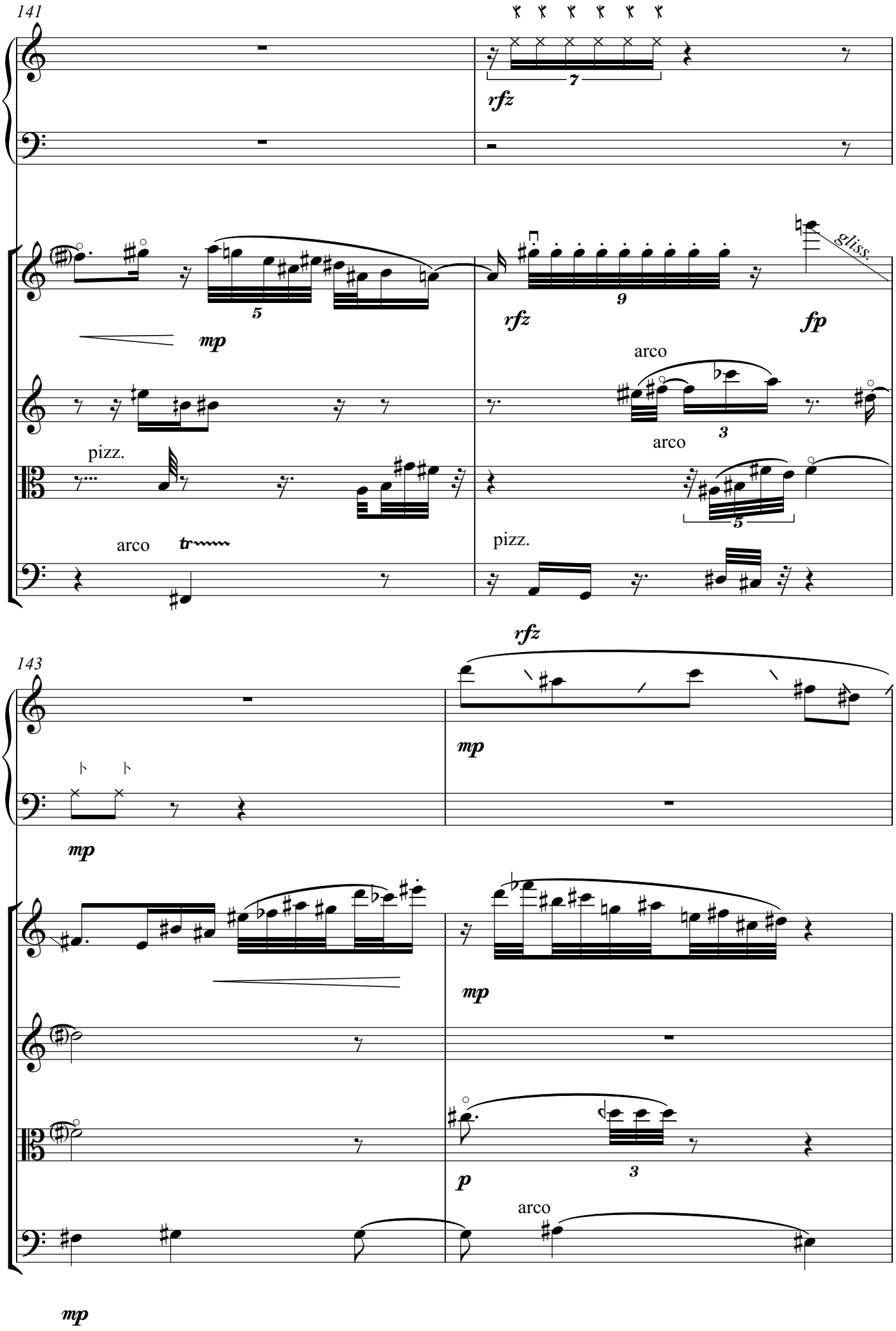
p mp pizz. pp

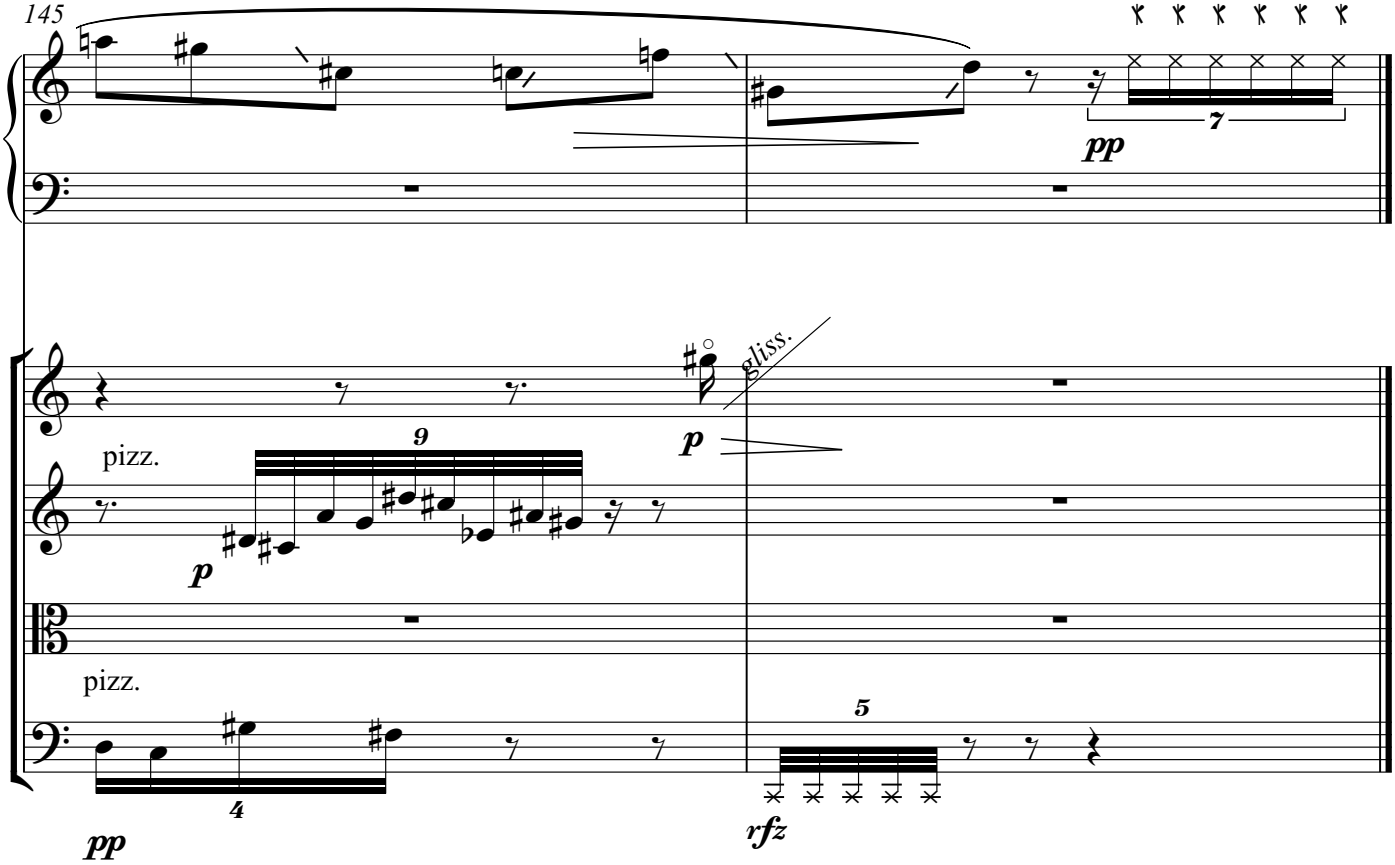
p p pizz. p

mp mf pizz. mp

mp rfz mp


con calma
131
♩=50
gliss.
mp
rfz
pizz.
pp
arco
p
pizz.
rfz
arco
mp
pizz.
mp
pizz.
pp
arco
p
139
arco
fp
pizz.
mp
arco
dim.
p
pizz.
rfz
p
dim.


141
rfz
mp
rfz
fp
gliss.
arco
pizz.
arco
arco
pizz.
143
rfz
mp
mp
mp
p
arco
mp


145
pp
7
gliss.
p
pizz.
9
p
pizz.
5
4
pp
rfz